```
    environment:
      MYSQL_ROOT_PASSWORD: root123
      MYSQL_DATABASE: testdb
```

This contains enough information to launch a minimally configured `mariadb` server container, using the `lts` (Long Term Support) tagged image. The environment variables ensure it starts with an empty database called `testdb`, and the password for the `root` account is "`root123`". We'll need these for the connection information in a moment. To start the server, simply invoke `docker compose up` in the directory where the `.yaml` exists.

```
$ docker compose up
...
 ✓ Network mariadb_default  Created
 ✓ Container mariadb        Created
Attaching to mariadb
mariadb  | 2025-08-28 11:09:07+00:00 [Note] [Entrypoint]: Entrypoint script
for MariaDB Server 1:11.4.3+maria~ubu2404 started.
...
```

There will be quite a few lines of output, plus the usual image-pull noise if this is the first time you've ever used the `mariadb:lts` image. This container is attached to the shell (`stdin`, etc.) you ran the docker command in, and it will continue to output its logs as it is used. That's fine for our purposes; just leave this running and open up a new command shell.

Connecting with PDO

The next thing we'll do is use PHP's PDO extension to connect to the server. You'll need to ensure that the necessary modules are installed:

```
$ php -m |grep -i 'pdo'
PDO
pdo_mysql
```

Both the `PDO` and `pdo_mysql` modules must be installed (grab them with your system package manager if not). If you are using the Docker images from this book's public Github repository, then these modules are already present in the image. To establish a